# 03. Gender, Religion and Caste

**Notes –**

**1. Differentiate between Gender and Religion.**

| Gender | Religion |
|---|---|
| 1. Gender refers to social differences between men and women. | 1. Religion refers to a system of faith, beliefs and practices. |
| 2. Gender differences are largely created by society and culture. | 2. Religious beliefs are based on faith and traditions. |
| 3. Gender division can lead to discrimination against women. | 3. Religious differences can sometimes lead to communalism. |
| 4. Gender issues focus on equality between men and women. | 4. Religious issues focus on relations among different religious communities. |

**2. What is a community? How is it different from caste?**

Community: A community is a group of people who share common interests, beliefs, culture, religion or a sense of belonging.

| Community | Caste |
|---|---|
| 1. It is a group of people having some common interests, beliefs or identity. | 1. It is a hereditary social group into which a person is generally born. |
| 2. A person can belong to a community based on religion, culture, region, etc. | 2. Caste traditionally determines social status and occupation. |
| 3. Communities are not necessarily arranged hierarchically. | 3. Caste groups have traditionally been arranged in a hierarchical order. |
| 4. Membership may not always be fixed by birth. | 4. Caste membership is generally determined by birth. |

**3. What do you mean by sexual division of labour? How can it be inferred in the politics of Indian society?**

Sexual division of labour refers to a system where work is divided between men and women based on their gender. Usually, women are expected to do household work while men are expected to work outside the home.

- Women perform a large share of unpaid domestic work.
- Men generally have greater participation in public and political activities.
- This division limits women's opportunities to participate in politics and decision-making.
- Therefore, women remain underrepresented in political institutions.

**4. What do you mean by feminism? How is a feminist movement depicted in Indian society?**

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Feminism is a movement that believes in equal rights and opportunities for women and men. It seeks to end discrimination against women and establish gender equality.

- Feminist movements have demanded equal opportunities in education and employment.
- They have demanded equal wages and property rights for women.
- They have opposed violence and discrimination against women.
- They have demanded greater political representation of women.

**5. What is a patriarchal society? Does this society have some disadvantages relevant to gender?**

A patriarchal society is a society in which men are considered the main authority in the family and society. Women are generally expected to remain subordinate to men.

- Men usually have greater power and decision-making authority.
- Women may face restrictions in education and employment.
- Women may have less access to property and other resources.
- They may have less participation in political and public life.
- Thus, patriarchy leads to gender inequality and discrimination.

**6. How do women face discrimination in India?**

- Women often have fewer educational opportunities than men.
- They may receive lower wages than men for similar work.
- Women perform a large share of unpaid household work.
- They have traditionally had less representation in politics.
- Women may also face harassment, violence and unequal treatment in society.

**7. Define Equal Remuneration Act, 1976.**

The Equal Remuneration Act, 1976 was enacted to provide equal remuneration to men and women workers for the same or similar work. It aimed to prevent discrimination against women in matters of wages and employment. The Act recognised that women should not be paid less than men merely because of their gender when they perform the same or similar work.

**8. What constitutional provisions have been made to fight discrimination on the basis of gender, religion and caste?**

- The Constitution guarantees equality before law.
- It prohibits discrimination on grounds of religion, race, caste and sex.
- It provides equal opportunities in public employment.
- Untouchability has been abolished.

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- Special provisions are allowed for women and disadvantaged groups to promote equality and social justice.

**9. Differentiate between uneducated and illiterate.**

| Uneducated | Illiterate |
|---|---|
| 1. A person who has received little or no formal education. | 1. A person who cannot read or write with understanding. |
| 2. It is a broader term. | 2. It specifically refers to lack of basic literacy. |
| 3. An uneducated person may still know how to read and write. | 3. An illiterate person may have no basic reading and writing skills. |
| 4. Lack of education does not always mean illiteracy. | 4. Illiteracy indicates a lack of basic literacy skills. |

**10. Mention different aspects of life in which women are discriminated or disadvantaged in India.**

Women face discrimination in several areas of life. These include education, employment, wages, household work, property ownership and political representation. Women often receive fewer opportunities for higher education and employment and may be paid less for similar work. They also perform a large share of unpaid domestic work and have historically had less participation in decision-making and political institutions.

**11. State different forms of communal politics with one example each.**

- Religious prejudices and stereotypes: Believing that one's religion is superior to others.
- Majoritarian dominance: One religious community tries to dominate other communities.
- Political mobilisation: Using religious symbols, leaders or emotions to gain political support.
- Communal violence: Conflicts or riots taking place between different religious communities.

**12. State how caste inequalities are still continuing in India.**

Caste inequalities continue in India despite constitutional safeguards. Many people still face discrimination and exclusion because of their caste. Economic differences also remain connected with caste, as historically disadvantaged castes often have fewer resources and opportunities. Caste-based inequalities can be seen in access to education, employment, land and social status. However, democratic politics and affirmative action have helped reduce some inequalities.

**13. State two reasons to say that caste alone cannot determine election results in India.**

- No constituency has a clear majority of voters belonging to one caste, so candidates need support from different caste groups.
- Voters do not always vote according to caste. They also consider political parties, candidates, their performance, policies and other issues.

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**14. What is the status of women's representation in India's legislative bodies?**

Women have historically had low representation in India's legislative bodies. Their share in Parliament and state assemblies has remained much lower than their proportion in the population. However, women's representation has increased over time, particularly in local government institutions because seats are reserved for women in Panchayats and Municipalities. The Constitution has also provided for greater representation of women through reservation measures.

**-THE END-**

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Sources: Ved Prakash Pandey Sir – Questions

NCERT – Democratic Politics for class 10

ChatGPT – Answers

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